SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

4 September 2023 · Shift 1

45 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 45 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving 1 question

Q.9

Six people, Karan, Dilip, Rahul, Prabhat, Alok and Sandeep are sitting in a straight line, facing north. Karan sits 2nd from the left end. Dilip sits 3rd to the right of Karan. Rahul sits 2nd to the left of Dilip. Prabhat sits 3rd to the right of Rahul. Sandeep sits 2nd to the left of Prabhat. Who sits 2nd to the right of Karan?

(A) Rahul
(B) Sandeep
(C) Prabhat
(D) Alok

General Awareness 20 questions

Q.1

The Padma Shri awardee Guru K Kalyanasundaram Pillai, the man who is keeping an ancient tradition alive,was awarded the Padma Shri 2023 for his contribution to the field of _____.

(A) Kuchipudi
(B) Kathakali
(C) Bharatanatyam
(D) Mohiniyattam

Q.2

Who appoints the State Election Commissioner?

(A) Governor
(B) Speaker
(C) Chief Minister
(D) Advocate General

Q.3

In which river has the National Waterways-2 (NW-2) been developed in India?

(A) Brahmaputra
(B) Krishna
(C) Ganga
(D) Narmada

Q.4

In India, Micro Finance Institutions primarily target which segment of the population?

(A) Non-resident Indians (NRIs)
(B) Large corporations
(C) Low-income individuals and small businesses
(D) High-income individuals

Q.5

What is the name of the scheme launched by Himachal Pradesh government for dairy farmers?

(A) Dhugdh Dhan
(B) Pashu Poshan
(C) Dhoodh aur Dhan
(D) Sanjeevani

Q.6

Which of the following States will host the 37th National Games?

(A) Odisha
(B) Andhra Pradesh
(C) Goa
(D) Karnataka

Q.7

Kalidas Samman is a prestigious arts award presented annually by the government of _____.

(A) Madhya Pradesh
(B) Rajasthan
(C) Kerala
(D) Karnataka

Q.8

How many countries will participate in ICC 2023 ODI Cricket World Cup?

(A) 12
(B) 10
(C) 6
(D) 8

Q.10

Which of the following is NOT a characteristic of money?

(A) Portability
(B) Perishability
(C) Divisibility
(D) Durability

Q.12

_____ has two traditions: one is the sankeertana (which is the devotional aspect) and the other is the raasa.

(A) Odissi
(B) Sattriya
(C) Manipuri dance
(D) Chhau

Q.13

Which of the following lakes is a saltwater lake ?

(A) Superior
(B) Chilika
(C) Malawi
(D) Titicaca

Q.15

The _____ of the Indian Constitution defines the Fundamental Duties of Indian Citizens.

(A) Article 51A
(B) Article 41B
(C) Article 49C
(D) Article 21A

Q.17

What type of vegetation is represented by Sundarbans, the world's largest delta located in the Bay of Bengal?

(A) Tropical Thorn Forests
(B) Montane Forests
(C) Mangrove Forests
(D) Semi Evergreen Forests

Q.18

The Mumbai High region in Arabian Sea is known for mining _____.

(A) uranium
(B) coal
(C) copper
(D) mineral oil

Q.19

In which of the following years was the Child Marriage Restraint Act passed?

(A) 1949
(B) 1939
(C) 1950
(D) 1929

Q.20
According to the Census of India 2011, identify the correct pair of State and Union Territories which recorded the highest literacy rate.

(A) Mizoram and Lakshadweep
(B) Kerala and Chandigarh
(C) Goa and Puducherry
(D) Kerala and Lakshadweep

Q.21
The sal tree assumes great significance in a number of tribal communities scattered across eastern India. For instance, _____ festival is celebrated in honour of the tree in Jharkhand.

(A) Karma
(B) Tusu Parab
(C) Sarhul
(D) Sohrai

Q.22
Geto Sora won the Arena Junior (Boys) International Badminton Championship. He belongs to which state?

(A) Arunachal Pradesh
(B) Mizoram
(C) Sikkim
(D) Meghalaya

Q.24
Which of the following Indian musicians was referred to as 'Ghazal King'?

(A) Ghulam Ali
(B) Jagjit Singh
(C) Pankaj Udhas
(D) Mehdi Hassan

Q.25
On 8th April 1929, who among the following two revolutionists threw a bomb in the Central Legislative Assembly?

(A) Bhagat Singh and Rajguru
(B) Bhagat Singh and Ram Prasad Bismil
(C) Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt
(D) Bhagat Singh and Sukhdev

English Language and Comprehension 24 questions

Q.1
Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. To go away suddenly and secretly in order to escape from somewhere

(A) Abscond
(B) Vanish
(C) Excavate
(D) Extradite

Q.2
Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom. My friend's business has grown "by leaps and bounds".

(A) rapidly
(B) aimlessly
(C) perfectly
(D) slowly

Q.3
Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. Peer pressure is bound "to effect most of us" both positively and negatively.

(A) to invoke most of us
(B) to affect most of us
(C) to impede most of us
(D) to prompt most of us

Q.4
Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Peculiar

(A) Neat
(B) Normal
(C) Strange
(D) Jovial

Q.5

Select the sentence that has NO spelling errors.

(A) The teacher was impressed with the student's insightfull analysis of the novel, which demonstrated a deep understanding of the complex theames and motifs.

(B) The teacher was impressed with the student's insightful analysis of the novel, which demonstrated a deep understanding of the complex themes and motifs.

(C) The teacher was imprresed with the student's insightul analysis of the novel, which demonstrated a deep understanding of the complex themes and motifes.

(D) The teacher was impresed with the student's insightful analysis of the novel, which demonstreted a deep understanding of the complex themes and motifs.

Q.6

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Beginning

(B) Writting

(C) Argument

(D) Amateur

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the following sentence. Tim joined the family business as he failed in his final degree examination. Seeing the growth of the family business now, it seems like Tim's earlier failure was "a blessing in disguise".

(A) A difficult time

(B) A mistake

(C) Something good that isn't recognised at first

(D) A good decision

Q.8

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error and select the option which rectifies that error. AI fiction is a constantly / evolving genre that gives us an peek / into the potential upsides and downsides / of intelligent machines.

(A) AI fiction is an constantly

(B) into a potential upside and downside

(C) evolving genre that gives us a peek

(D) of intelligent machine.

Q.9

Parts of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains an error. "If he" "will come" early, "we will" leave "on time".

(A) will come

(B) If he

(C) on time

(D) we will

Q.10

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the following sentence. I ordered a dozen doughnuts, but the kind baker gave me "a baker's dozen".

(A) A group of 12 bakery items

(B) A group of 12 bakers

(C) A group of 13

(D) A group of 12

Q.11

Parts of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains an error. They "had two" "bedrooms among" "them, one for" the "girls and one" for the boys.

(A) girls and one

(B) them, one for

(C) bedrooms among

(D) had two

Q.13

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Wisdom

(A) Stupidity
(B) Experience
(C) Modesty
(D) Intelligence

Q.14

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Jack being the wiser and “bolder among” the two of us, took the lead, carrying the axe on his shoulder.

(A) bolder between
(B) boldest among
(C) No improvement required
(D) boldest between

Q.15

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined group of words. Many people fought to “put an end to” slavery during the civil war.

(A) abolish
(B) absorb
(C) abide
(D) abduct

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word given in brackets to fill in the blank. The doctor said that the patient named Rumi is in the _____(initial) stage of lung cancer.

(A) terminal
(B) innermost
(C) early
(D) outermost

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. He generally avoids arguments as he is _____ by nature.

(A) questionable
(B) reliable
(C) quick-minded
(D) peaceful

Q.18

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution required’. The pandemic has challenged “education systems to ensure learning” continuity, substantially increasing the demands placed on teachers.

(A) education systems to ensuring learning
(B) education systems for ensure learning
(C) education systems in ensure learning
(D) No substitution required

Q.19

Select the most appropriate idiom from the given options to fill in the blank. We broke the traffic rules unknowingly while coming back from the party, now we have to _____ sooner or later.

(A) face the music
(B) look sharp
(C) cry for the moon
(D) bid defiance

Q.20

The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Guard over / making mistakes / by carefully checking / the assigned task.

(A) Guard over
(B) by carefully checking
(C) the assigned task
(D) making mistakes

Q.21

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. _____(1) university or college degree has long been the traditional hallmark of a _____ (2) candidate in the professional arena. While it historically provided the most widely accepted standard of qualification and skill for professionals, many companies today _____ (3) their hiring process and considering a broader list of criteria to judge a candidate's ability. Organisations are reducing their reliance on college degrees as a sole marker of competence and instead placing greater emphasis _____ (4) the practical skills candidates have acquired through work experience. This shift in hiring is of particular relevance to India, which has the _____ (5) youth population in the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) The
(B) That
(C) A
(D) An

Q.22

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. _____(1) university or college degree has long been the traditional hallmark of a _____ (2) candidate in the professional arena. While it historically provided the most widely accepted standard of qualification and skill for professionals, many companies today _____ (3) their hiring process and considering a broader list of criteria to judge a candidate's ability. Organisations are reducing their reliance on college degrees as a sole marker of competence and instead placing greater emphasis _____ (4) the practical skills candidates have acquired through work experience. This shift in hiring is of particular relevance to India, which has the _____ (5) youth population in the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) was qualify
(B) qualify
(C) qualification
(D) qualified

Q.23

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. _____(1) university or college degree has long been the traditional hallmark of a _____ (2) candidate in the professional arena. While it historically provided the most widely accepted standard of qualification and skill for professionals, many companies today _____ (3) their hiring process and considering a broader list of criteria to judge a candidate's ability. Organisations are reducing their reliance on college degrees as a sole marker of competence and instead placing greater emphasis _____ (4) the practical skills candidates have acquired through work experience. This shift in hiring is of particular relevance to India, which has the _____ (5) youth population in the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) was changed
(B) was changing
(C) changing
(D) are changing

Q.24

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. _____(1) university or college degree has long been the traditional hallmark of a _____ (2) candidate in the professional arena. While it historically provided the most widely accepted standard of qualification and skill for professionals, many companies today _____ (3) their hiring process and considering a broader list of criteria to judge a candidate's ability. Organisations are reducing their reliance on college degrees as a sole marker of competence and instead placing greater emphasis _____ (4) the practical skills candidates have acquired through work experience. This shift in hiring is of particular relevance to India, which has the _____ (5) youth population in the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) about
(B) for
(C) with
(D) on

Q.25

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. _____(1) university or college degree has long been the traditional hallmark of a _____ (2) candidate in the professional arena. While it historically provided the most widely accepted standard of qualification and skill for professionals, many companies today _____ (3) their hiring process and considering a broader list of criteria to judge a candidate's ability. Organisations are reducing their reliance on college degrees as a sole marker of competence and instead placing greater emphasis _____ (4) the practical skills candidates have acquired through work experience. This shift in hiring is of particular relevance to India, which has the _____ (5) youth population in the world.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) largest
(B) longest
(C) biggest
(D) most highest

Answer key

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.9 **(B)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(B)**	Q.15 **(A)**
Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(A)**
Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(C)**				

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.13 **(A)**
Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(D)**	Q.25 **(A)**

Explanations

Reasoning Ability and Problem Solving

Q.9 · Answer (B) Sandeep

Karan is 2nd from the left, Dilip 5th, Rahul 3rd, Prabhat 6th and Sandeep 4th, leaving Alok 1st. From the left: Alok, Karan, Rahul, Sandeep, Dilip, Prabhat, so Sandeep sits second to Karan's right.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Bharatanatyam

K. Kalyanasundaram Pillai, a Bharatanatyam guru of the Thanjavur tradition, received the Padma Shri in 2023 for his work in Bharatanatyam.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Governor

Under Article 243K the State Election Commissioner, who conducts panchayat elections, is appointed by the Governor.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Brahmaputra

National Waterway 2 is the Sadiya-Dhubri stretch of the Brahmaputra in Assam, about 891 km long.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Low-income individuals and small businesses

Microfinance institutions give small loans and other financial services to low-income households and small businesses that ordinary banks often do not reach.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Sanjeevani

In April 2023 Himachal Pradesh's Animal Husbandry Department started 'Sanjeevani', with Bharat Financial Inclusion Ltd (a subsidiary of IndusInd Bank), to give small dairy farmers veterinary care for their livestock at their doorstep.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Goa

Goa hosted the 37th National Games in October-November 2023, after Gujarat had hosted the 36th in 2022.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Madhya Pradesh

The Kalidas Samman, named after the Sanskrit poet Kalidasa, has been given by the Government of Madhya Pradesh since 1980 for excellence in the arts.

Q.8 · Answer (B) 10

Ten teams took part in the 2023 ICC Men's Cricket World Cup, held in India in October-November 2023.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Perishability

Money must be durable, portable and divisible to serve as a medium of exchange and a store of value; something perishable would lose its value as it decayed.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Manipuri dance

Manipuri dance has two traditions: the Sankirtana, its devotional singing and drumming, and the Raas, the Ras Lila of Radha and Krishna.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Chilika

Chilika, on the Odisha coast, is a brackish-water lagoon, the largest in Asia. Superior, Malawi and Titicaca are freshwater lakes.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Article 51A

Article 51A, in Part IVA, added by the 42nd Amendment in 1976, lists the Fundamental Duties of citizens.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Mangrove Forests

The Sundarbans, in the Ganga-Brahmaputra delta, are the largest mangrove forest in the world; mangroves grow in the tidal, salty swamps of coasts and deltas.

Q.18 · Answer (D) mineral oil
Mumbai High, an offshore field in the Arabian Sea off the Mumbai coast discovered in 1974, produces petroleum (mineral oil) and natural gas.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 1929
The Child Marriage Restraint Act (the Sarda Act), moved by Har Bilas Sarda, was passed in 1929 and came into force in 1930.

Q.20 · Answer (D) Kerala and Lakshadweep
In the 2011 Census Kerala had the highest literacy rate among the states (about 94%) and Lakshadweep among the Union territories (about 92%).

Q.21 · Answer (C) Sarhul
Sarhul, the spring festival of Jharkhand's tribes such as the Oraon and the Munda, worships the sal tree when it blossoms. Karma honours the karam tree.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Arunachal Pradesh
Geto Sora, a child badminton player from Arunachal Pradesh, won the under-9 boys' singles title at this junior international championship in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia, in December 2022.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Jagjit Singh
SSC's key gives Jagjit Singh, the Indian singer widely called the 'Ghazal King' for bringing the ghazal to a mass audience. Mehdi Hassan, also hailed as the king of the ghazal, was Pakistani, as is Ghulam Ali.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt
On 8 April 1929 Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt threw bombs, meant to make a noise rather than kill, into the Central Legislative Assembly in Delhi in protest against the Public Safety Bill and the Trade Disputes Bill, and courted arrest.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) Abscond
To 'abscond' is to leave secretly and in a hurry, usually to escape arrest or a duty. 'Vanish' lacks the sense of escape, and 'extradite' is to hand someone over to another country.

Q.2 · Answer (A) rapidly
To grow 'by leaps and bounds' is to grow very quickly.

Q.3 · Answer (B) to affect most of us
'Affect' is the verb meaning to influence; as a verb, 'effect' means to bring about: 'bound to affect most of us'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Strange
'Peculiar' means odd or unusual: 'strange'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) The teacher was impressed with the student’s insightful analysis of the novel, which demonstrated a deep understanding of the complex themes and motifs.
Only this sentence spells every word correctly. The others have 'insightfull' and 'theames', 'imprresed', 'insightul' and 'motifes', or 'impresed' and 'demonstreted'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Writting
The correct spelling is 'writing', with one t.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Something good that isn't recognised at first
A 'blessing in disguise' is something that seems unfortunate at first but turns out well, as Tim's failure did.

Q.8 · Answer (C) evolving genre that gives us a peek
'Peek' begins with a consonant sound, so it takes 'a', not 'an': 'gives us a peek'.

Q.9 · Answer (A) will come
In a first conditional the if-clause takes the simple present, not 'will': 'If he comes early, we will leave on time.'

Q.10 · Answer (C) A group of 13
A 'baker's dozen' is thirteen: bakers traditionally added one extra item to a dozen.

Q.11 · Answer (C) bedrooms among
Something shared out by two parties takes 'between': the rooms were divided between the girls and the boys, 'two bedrooms between them'.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Stupidity
'Wisdom' is good judgement; its opposite is 'stupidity'.

Q.14 · Answer (A) bolder between
Two people are compared, so the comparative 'bolder' stays, and 'among' (for more than two) gives way to 'between'. ('Of the two of us' is the more usual phrasing, but it is not offered.)

Q.15 · Answer (A) abolish
To 'abolish' is to put an end to a system or practice officially, as slavery was abolished.

Q.16 · Answer (A) terminal
'Initial' means at the beginning; its opposite is 'terminal', at the final stage. 'Early' means the same as 'initial'.

Q.17 · Answer (D) peaceful
Someone who avoids arguments is 'peaceful' by nature.

Q.18 · Answer (D) No substitution required
'Challenge someone to do something' takes the infinitive, so 'education systems to ensure learning' is correct as it stands.

Q.19 · Answer (A) face the music
To 'face the music' is to accept the consequences of what one has done.

Q.20 · Answer (A) Guard over
One guards 'against' a danger or mistake: 'Guard against making mistakes by carefully checking the assigned task.'

Q.21 · Answer (C) A
'University' begins with a consonant sound (yoo), so it takes 'a', not 'an'; the indefinite article speaks of any such degree in general.

Q.22 · Answer (D) qualified
An adjective is needed before 'candidate': 'a qualified candidate'.

Q.23 · Answer (D) are changing
The plural subject 'many companies' and the parallel 'and considering' call for the present continuous: 'are changing their hiring process'.

Q.24 · Answer (D) on
One places emphasis 'on' something.

Q.25 · Answer (A) largest
SSC's key gives 'largest': the size of a population is described with 'large', so 'the largest youth population'. ('Biggest' is also heard informally; 'longest' does not fit and 'most highest' is a double superlative.)

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